



American Board
of Internal Medicine®

Recognition as a Strategy

ABMS Conference 2026

September 17, 2026

Disclosure

- **Nothing to Disclose**

Today's Agenda

- **Reflection (10 min)**
- **Project Background (5 min)**
- **Recognition Initiatives (30 min)**
 - Digital Badges
 - Over 30 Years Certified
 - LKA Wrapped
 - ABIM Collection
- **Applying Lessons Learned (15 min)**



Nicole Welk-Joerger, PhD (she/her/hers)

Program Manager, Stakeholder Engagement
American Board of Internal Medicine



Lindsay Durkalec (she/her/hers)

Manager, Marketing and PR
ABIM



Patrick Prante, MS (he/him/his)

Data Analyst, Assessment Research &
Innovations
ABIM, Pennsylvania

Reflection

Reflection (Write and Talk)

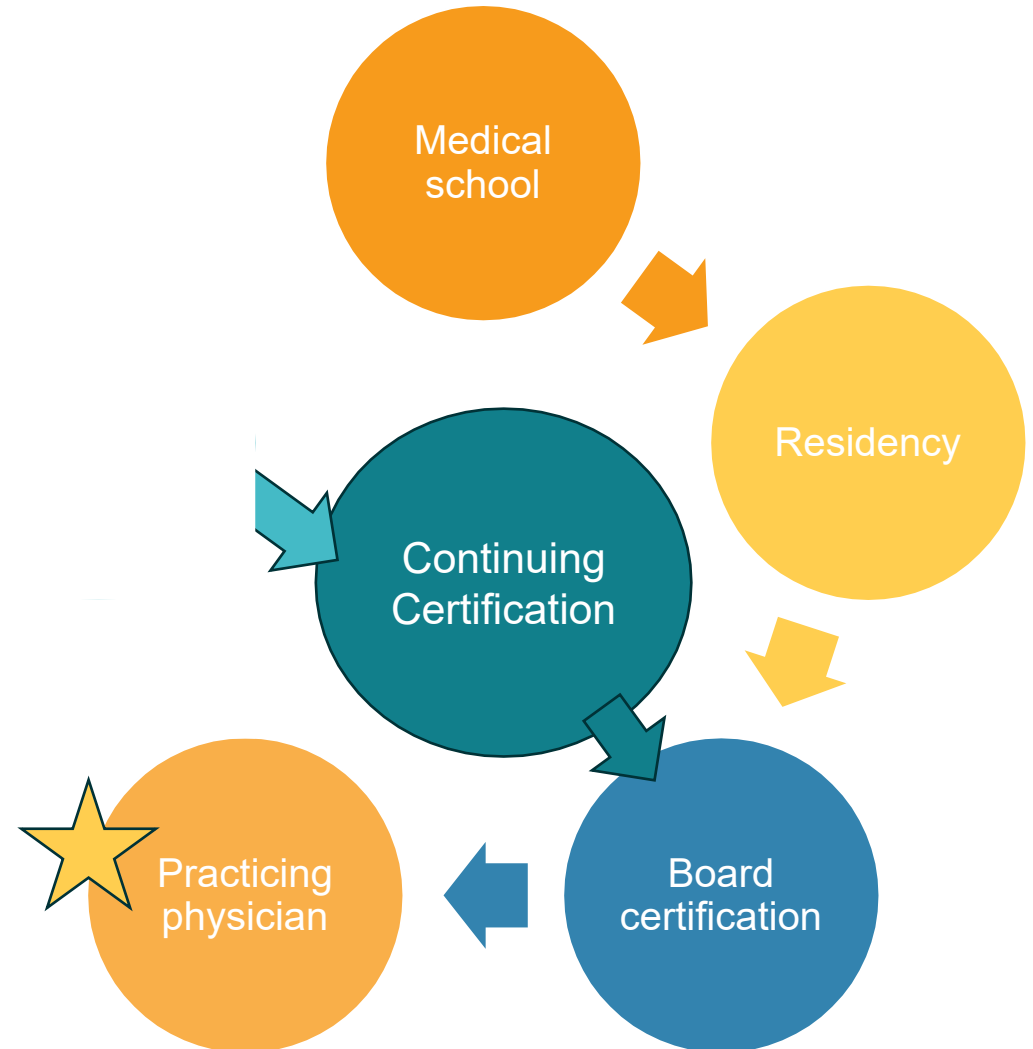
Think about a time when you felt like you were *recognized*, or *appreciated*, or *celebrated* for your work.

Who recognized you and how did they do it?

Project Background

ABIM Maintenance of Certification (MOC) Experience

- Disruption of a previous "rite of passage" framework
 - Crucial to personal and professional understandings of meeting a milestone
- Exploring a shift in the value of focus
 - From **not** losing certification to recognizing continued efforts



Research: The Starting Point



Interviews

Completed 18
interviews with ABIM
Community Insights
Network



Focus Groups

With 14 Specialty
Boards and Advisory
Committees and the
LKA Advisory Panel



Other Member Boards

Met with colleagues
about their methods
and lessons learned

Feedback from
126 physicians
with **over 12 hours**
of recorded
conversations

Two Approaches to Recognition

Intrinsic Approach:

ABIM focuses on individual diplomate (relationship/sentiments with org)

- Positive messaging
- Highlighting significant milestones
 - Making process easier

Extrinsic Approach:

ABIM focuses on patients and employers (elevating the value of board certification to others)

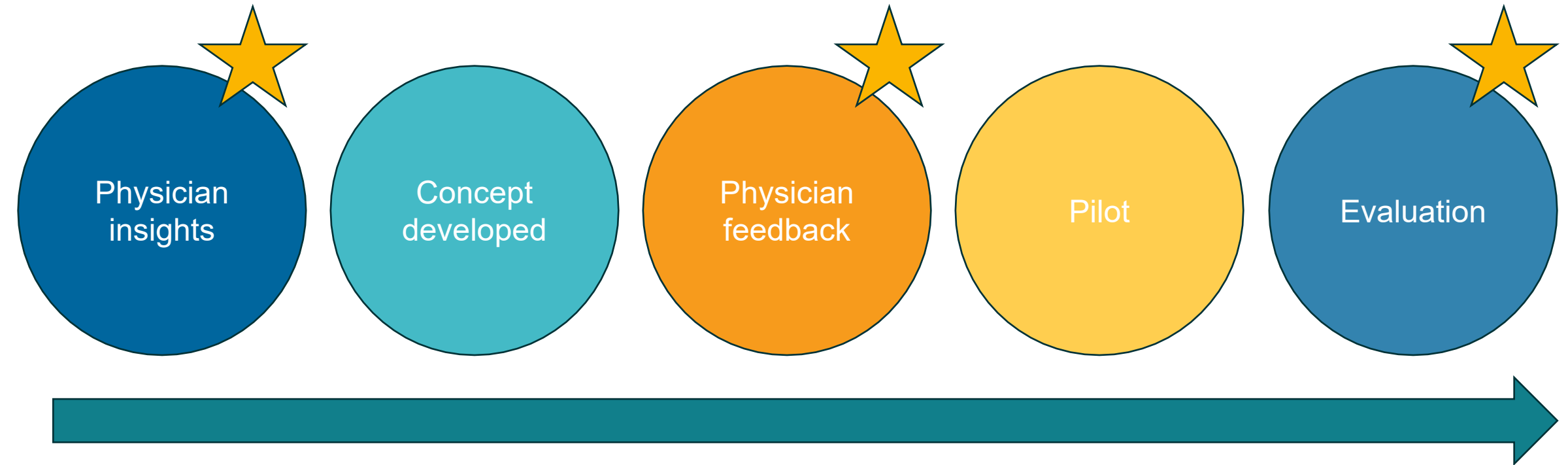
- Patient-focused campaigns
- Direct-to-employer communication
- Enhanced/integrated web profiles

Main Challenge with Intrinsic Approach

If ABIM MOC is **required/considered the bare minimum**, **what is recognition aiming to do**? Respond to those who already believe in the program, or respond to those critical of it?

- **"We don't really belong to the ABIM.** You just make sure we're not dangerous."
(Interview #4)
- **"...you are expected to accomplish that so that takes away the recognition part of it. It's just part of life**, you have to take care of it." (Interview #1)
- **"MOC is required... it is the bare minimum."** (Infectious Disease, Rheumatology, HPM, and Medical Oncology SBs)
- **"It's the minimum, why would you flaunt it?"** (Nephrology SB)

Research: The Anchor



Recognition Strategy

Goals

- **Improve physician experiences** with the initial certification and continuing certification programs
- **Increase positive physician interactions** with multiple touchpoints for celebratory communications
- **Continue to build positive and meaningful relationships** with physicians

Strategic Pillars

Timely and
Authentic
Recognition

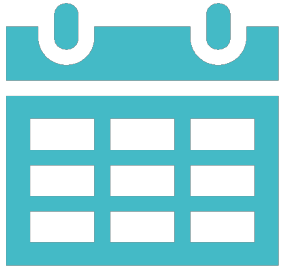
Integrated
Communications

Physician-
Focused
Messaging

Consistent and
Predictable
Communications

Feedback and
Continuous
Improvement

Intrinsic Recognition Initiatives



**Over 30 Years
Certified**



Digital Badges



**LKA End-of-Year
Email**



ABIM Collection

Over 30 Years Certified

What We Heard

- Celebrating anniversaries (work, education) are meaningful forms of recognition

Statements included:

- "It would be nice to get recognized for how many years we've been certified."
- "I remember receiving a gift after working [at the hospital] for over 15 years."



Over 30 Years Recognition Kit



**Board Certified
Physician**
For Over 30 Years

Celebrating Your Years of Certification

Your career in medicine has included many different achievements, with board certification serving as a part of your longer professional journey.

To stay certified throughout your career, and continue to maintain board certification today, demonstrates your commitment to staying current with the knowledge, skills and judgment essential for excellent patient care. And to do this for over 30 years is a remarkable accomplishment.

Included in this recognition kit are the following:

- Your 30 Years Certified recognition certificate
- A lapel pin
- A sticker decal – to signal board certification in your office or practice

Thank you again for your commitment to the patients you serve as an ABIM Board Certified physician. Congratulations on your remarkable achievement!

Questions or feedback? Please email ABIM's Engagement Team at community@abim.org.

THE AMERICAN BOARD OF INTERNAL MEDICINE
INCORPORATED 1936

HEREBY ACKNOWLEDGES THAT

John Diplomate

HAS MAINTAINED CERTIFICATION FOR OVER

THIRTY YEARS

DEMONSTRATING AN ONGOING COMMITMENT TO
STAYING CURRENT IN KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTICE

ROBERT O. BOWTELL, MD
CHAIR, ABIM BOARD OF DIRECTORS

KRISHNA H. CHAITANYASHATI, MD
CHAIR-ELECT, ABIM BOARD OF DIRECTORS



LAURA E. EVANS, MD
CHAIR, ABIM COUNCIL

FURMAN S. McDONALD, MD
ABIM PRESIDENT

ABIM# 000000

YEAR ISSUED: 2025



American Board
of Internal Medicine®

RECOGNIZING YOUR

Achievement



**Board Certified
Physician**
For Over 30 Years



Of the Profession, For the Public

ABIM's Mission:
To enhance the quality of health care by certifying internists
and subspecialists who demonstrate the knowledge, skills and
attitudes essential for excellent patient care.

Over 30 Years Certified Digital Badge



Of the Profession, For the Public®

[Learn More about ABIM](#)

[Sign In](#)

ABIM Certified

26,820 Directory Members

Search by... Profile Name ▾ Default (Most completed) ▾

Viewing 1-20 of 26,820

< Page 1 of 1341 >

Filters

Credentials

☐ Over 30 Years Certified

Specialty

- ☐ Adolescent Medicine
- ☐ Adult Congenital Heart Disease
- ☐ Advanced Heart Failure and Transplant Cardiology
- ☐ Cardiovascular Disease
- ☐ Clinical Cardiac Electrophysiology



Michael Martin 📍 Tulsa, OK, USA

University of Texas MD Anderson University of Texas Health Sciences University of Texas at Austin

Skills: Continuous Professional Development - Maintenance of Certification - Medical Knowledge
+1 more skill



Over 30 Years Certified

Specialty: Gastroenterology



Subodh Saggi 📍 New York, NY, USA

I am a Nephrologist and currently Profesor of Medicine at SUNY Downstate Health Sciences Univeristy, Brooklyn, New York. I am also the Program Director for Nephrology and Medical Director for Ambulatory and Home Dialysis programs.

Skills: Continuous Professional Development - Maintenance of Certification - Medical Knowledge
+1 more skill



Over 30 Years Certified

Specialty: Internal Medicine, Nephrology



Joseph Hennessy 📍 Chicago, IL, USA

Senior Attending, Rush University Medical Center Team Physician, Chicago White Sox Volunteer Medical Director, Community Health



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Over 30 Years Certified

[SHARE](#) [DOWNLOAD](#) [EMAIL](#) [HELP](#) [MORE](#)

Recognition Kit Opt-In Rates

- Over 8,400 physicians claimed their “Over 30 Years Certified” pin and certificate
 - 26,800 physicians included in retroactive campaign
- **31% total opt-in rate** (and growing)
- **>42% opt-in** for those **50+ years** certified



Digital Badges

What We Heard

- Physicians appreciate (and sometimes expect) digital credentials for optimal online sharing

Statements included:

- "I just got a special online badge I can add to my email signature – could you do that?"
- "Will I get a digital badge for this?"



Volunteer Badges (2023-2026)



ABIM Board Certified Badge

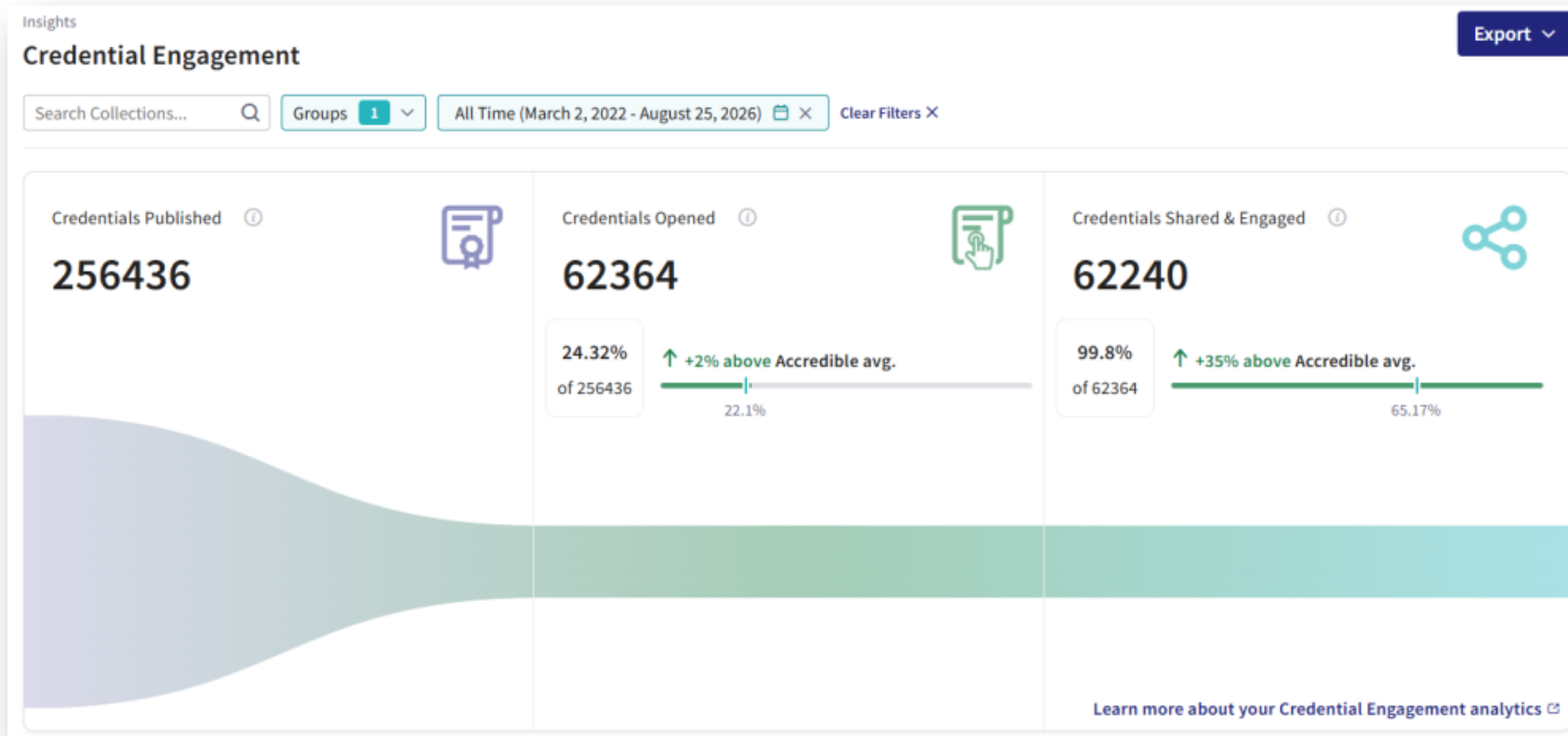
- Deliverables
 - Email Campaigns
 - 2 emails (via Salesforce & Accredible)
 - Digital Badge and Spotlight Directory
 - Landing page on ABIM.org
- Criteria
 - Board Certified in at least one specialty
 - Lifetime certification physicians included even if not participating in MOC
 - Standard exclusions (revoked, deceased, etc.)
- Total send: **256,436**



ABIM Board Certified Badge

Diplomates shared and engaged with badges using:

- LinkedIn
- WhatsApp
- Email
- Facebook
- SMS
- X
- Instagram
- Facebook Messenger
- Slack
- Bluesky
- Telegram
- YouTube
- TikTok



LKA End-of-Year Email

What We Heard

- Email is the best way to communicate, but the more personalized, the more meaningful

Statements included:

- "Generic emails with thanks or congratulations feel empty to me."
- "[ABIM] has information that is of interest to me about my community, can you share that more widely?"



Recognizing Your Year, Dr. [REDACTED]

Congratulations on another incredible year of staying current! As a board certified physician participating in Maintenance of Certification (MOC), you are continuing to demonstrate that you have the knowledge, skills and attitudes essential for excellent patient care. As 2024 closes, take a look back at your achievements and join us in celebrating your dedication to staying current. More than 700,000 physicians like you are maintaining certification through member boards of the [American Board of Medical Specialties](#). We are proud to honor your participation alongside your ABIM board certified colleagues.

A 2024 Summary of Your Dedication to Staying Current

MY ABIM COMMUNITY

50
Years certified

<1%
Physicians certified as long as me
1408 out of 262,000 ABIM Board Certified physicians.

<1%
Physicians with the same combination of certifications:
Internal Medicine + Pulmonary + Sleep Medicine
380 out of 262,000 ABIM Board Certified physicians.

Participating in the **LONGITUDINAL KNOWLEDGE ASSESSMENT**

ONE in FOUR
Higher assessment scores are associated with better patient outcomes.

ABIM certification is associated with **BETTER PATIENT OUTCOMES**.
Higher assessment scores have shown...

30% improvement in patient outcomes
40% improvement in patient outcomes

Personalized greeting with ABMS community information

Personalized certification data with community comparison and value of certification research

MY LKA

Sleep Medicine

Of the 5-Year Cycle
Finishing Year 3

Average Time per Question
0.98 min

Most Difficult Question Answered Correctly
Treatment + Care Decisions for Adult obstructive sleep apnea
You really know your stuff!

Best Overall Content Area
Parasomnias & Sleep-Related Movements
You got more questions right in this area than others.

LKA-specific information highlighting strengths

MY LKA COMMUNITY

<1%
Physicians like me
Physicians with the same LKA exam.

70,500
Physicians taking the LKA

Most Difficult Topics
These case studies were the hardest ones for your fields this year.

Sleep Medicine:
Treatment + Care Decisions for Kleine-Levin syndrome (periodic hypersomnia)

Preparing for Next Year
See how you and your peers are performing in these and other areas with the [Specialty Knowledge Gaps Annual Reports](#) in each specialty.

LKA community data with Call to Action to Specialty Knowledge Gaps Reports

2025 Email



Recognizing Your Year, Dr. [REDACTED]

Congratulations on another year of staying current! As a board certified physician participating in Maintenance of Certification, you are demonstrating that you have the knowledge, skills and judgments essential for excellent patient care.

As 2025 ends, take a moment to reflect on your achievements and learn more about your community of peers.

Your 2025 Snapshot: Staying Current

MY ABIM COMMUNITY



62

Years certified



<1%

Physicians certified
as long as me or longer
85 out of 270,000 ABIM Board Certified
physicians.

<1%

Physicians with the same combination of certifications:

**Geriatric Medicine + Internal Medicine +
Rheumatology**

33 out of 270,000 ABIM Board Certified physicians.

Share the value of your board certification



My LKA



Geriatric Medicine



Of the 5-Year Cycle
Finishing Year 1



Average Time per Question
1.99 min



Most Difficult Question Answered Correctly

Description

Diseases in the Elderly

- Cardiovascular
- Peripheral arterial disease

Task

Pathophysiology and Basic Science

Based on the question's blueprint description.



Best Overall Content Area

Diseases in the Elderly

You got more questions right in this area than others.

MY LKA COMMUNITY



459

Physicians like me

Physicians with the same LKA exam
combination.



74,000

Physicians taking the LKA



Physicians in my Region

Physicians taking the LKA near me.

Texas

There are 17480 other physicians taking the LKA near me.



Most Difficult Topics in Geriatric Medicine

Description

Gerontology

- Psychology and sociology of aging
- Spirituality

Task

Pathophysiology and Basic Science

These case studies were the hardest ones for your field this year.



Preparing for Next Year

See how you and your peers are performing in these and
other areas with the Specialty Knowledge Gaps Annual
Reports in each specialty.

Please Share Your Feedback



Click a star to rate this email



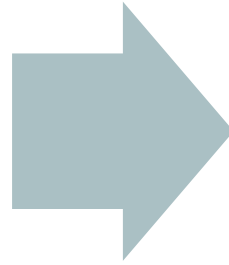
American Board
of Internal Medicine®

Of the profession, for the public

To enhance the quality of health care by certifying internists
and subspecialists who demonstrate the knowledge, skills and
attitudes essential for excellent patient care.



2024 Pilot



2025 Full-Scale Launch



Random sample from full 2024 population



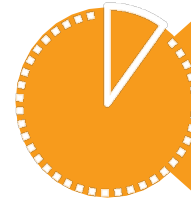
2750 Recipients



Positive feedback from pilot participants and ABIM Board members



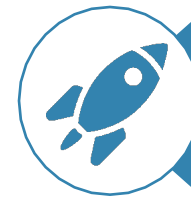
Built the template for the full scale launch



Full eligible population



72,400 Recipients



Full scale launch was successful

Expanding impact.
Celebrating more physicians.

Who Received the Full Experience?



Active LKA
Enrollment



Active ABIM
Certificate in
the Discipline



Valid Email on
File



Answered 40
Live
Questions
from Q1-Q3

*Some recipients enrolled in multiple LKA disciplines received partial data for exams where not enough live questions were answered.

Longitudinal Exam Enrollees



Engaged Audience

- Active Participants
- Frequent input data



LKA Visibility

- Increased engagement
- Highlight positives



Brand Connection

- Strengthen engagement with ABIM

Challenges



Maintain Test Security

Highlight exam blueprint rather than specific exam questions



Translate Data

Convert exam blueprint data into a consumable format, both to ensure context for recipients and remove special characters

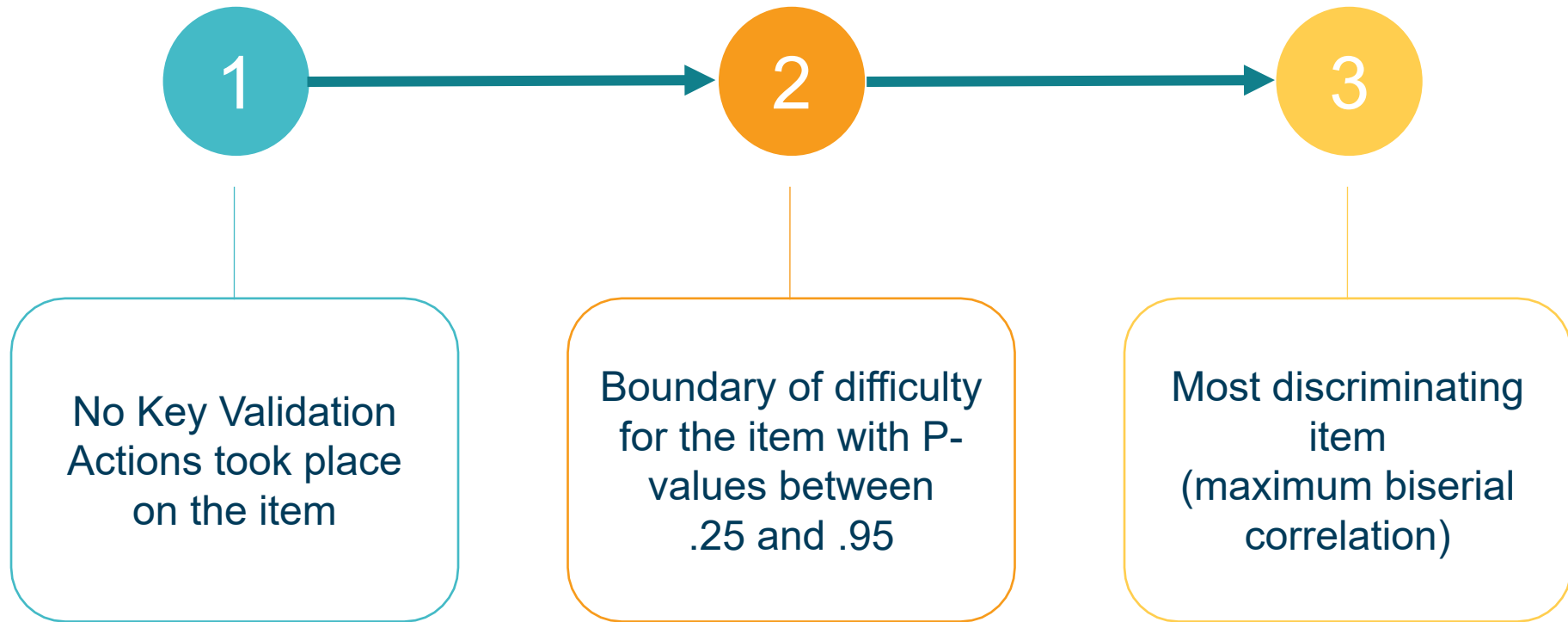


Ensure Scalability

Minimize manual review of large-scale data by finding universal solutions

Psychometric Details:

Most Difficult Topics in Discipline



Psychometric Details:

Best Overall Content Area

1. Meaningful Content Areas Only

- (i.e.) Miscellaneous

2. Minimum 4 Live Questions Answered

3. Highest Percent

4. Tie Breakers

- Most Live Items Answered
- Lowest Average P-Value Across Live Items

Medical Content Category	% of Exam
Allergy and Immunology	2%
Cardiovascular Disease	14%
Dermatology	3%
Endocrinology, Diabetes, and Metabolism	9%
Gastroenterology	9%
Hematology	6%
Infectious Disease	9%
Miscellaneous	2%
Nephrology and Urology	6%
Neurology	4%
Obstetrics and Gynecology	3%
Medical Oncology	6%
Ophthalmology	1%
Otolaryngology and Dental Medicine	1%
Psychiatry	4%
Pulmonary Disease	9%
Rheumatology and Orthopedics	9%
Geriatric Syndromes	3%
Total	100%

Psychometric Details:

Most Difficult Question Answered Correctly

Item Eligibility Criteria

- No Key Validation actions
- Biserial Correlation $\geq .14$
- Item answered correctly
- P-Value $\geq .25$

Selection Process

- Minimum P-Value
- Tie Break: Highest Biserial Correlation

The ABIM Collection

What We Heard

- ABIM-branded items are valued by physicians.

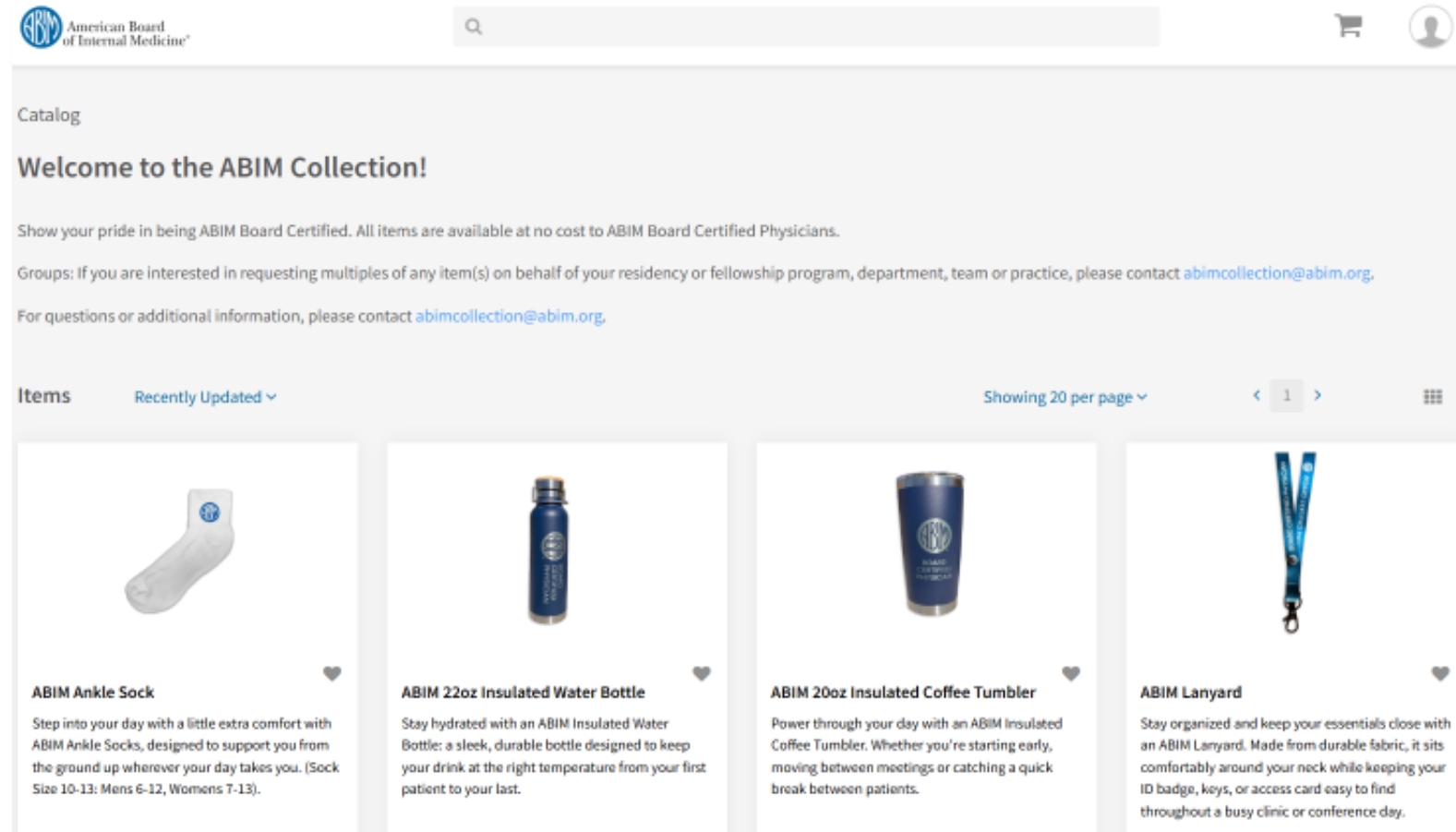
Statements included:

- "I loved the mug I got, and it's a good conversation piece."
- "Sometimes a small gift is enough to feel appreciated."



Introducing the ABIM Collection

- Any ABIM diplomate can order ABIM-branded items via the online platform
- All items are **completely free** to the diplomate (shipping included)
- Physicians can order individual items for themselves, or request bulk orders for groups such as residency programs or departments





ABIM 22oz Insulated Water Bottle



ABIM 20oz Insulated Coffee Tumbler



ABIM Ankle Sock



ABIM Retractable Badge Holder



ABIM Stethoscope Case



ABIM Lanyard



How it Works

ABIM American Board of Internal Medicine®

Checkout



ABIM American Board of Internal Medicine®



We have received your order!

We will send you an order confirmation email
ldurkalec@abim.org

Order Number: AMP314

Date: 8/20/2026

Delivery Method

UPS Ground

Soft Launch Findings (March-April 2026)

Total orders: **245**

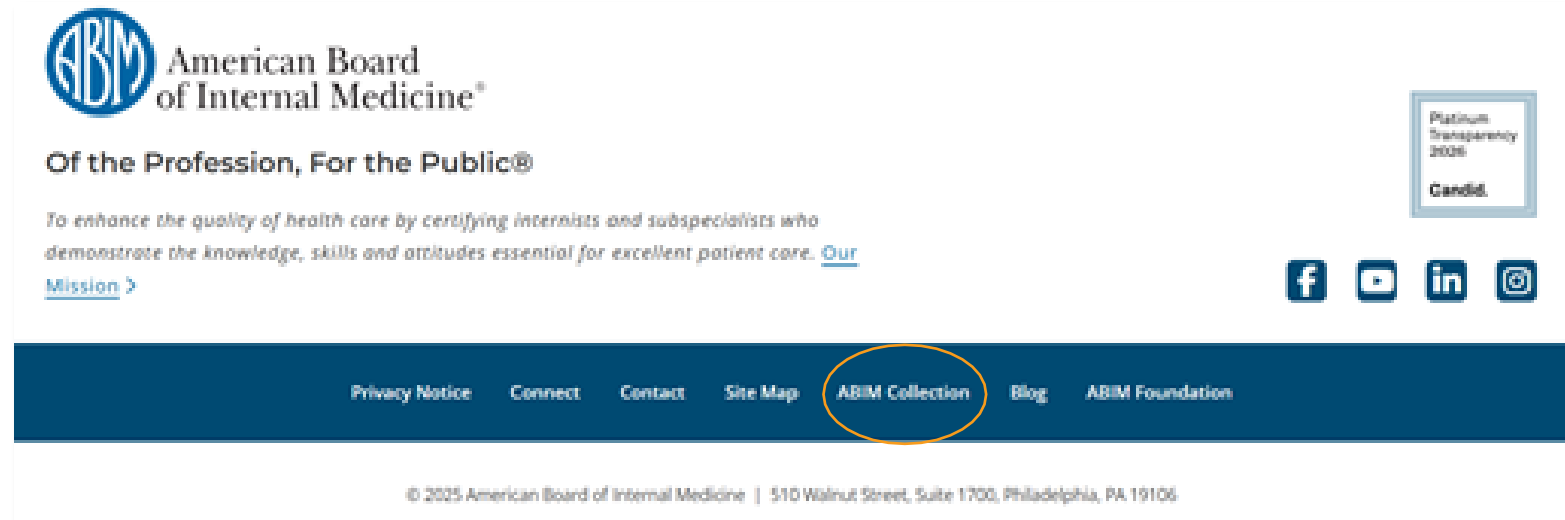
Total items requested: **1,600+**

Governance + Item-Writers opt-in rate: **23.5%**

Hottest items: **Insulated water bottle, coffee tumbler, socks**

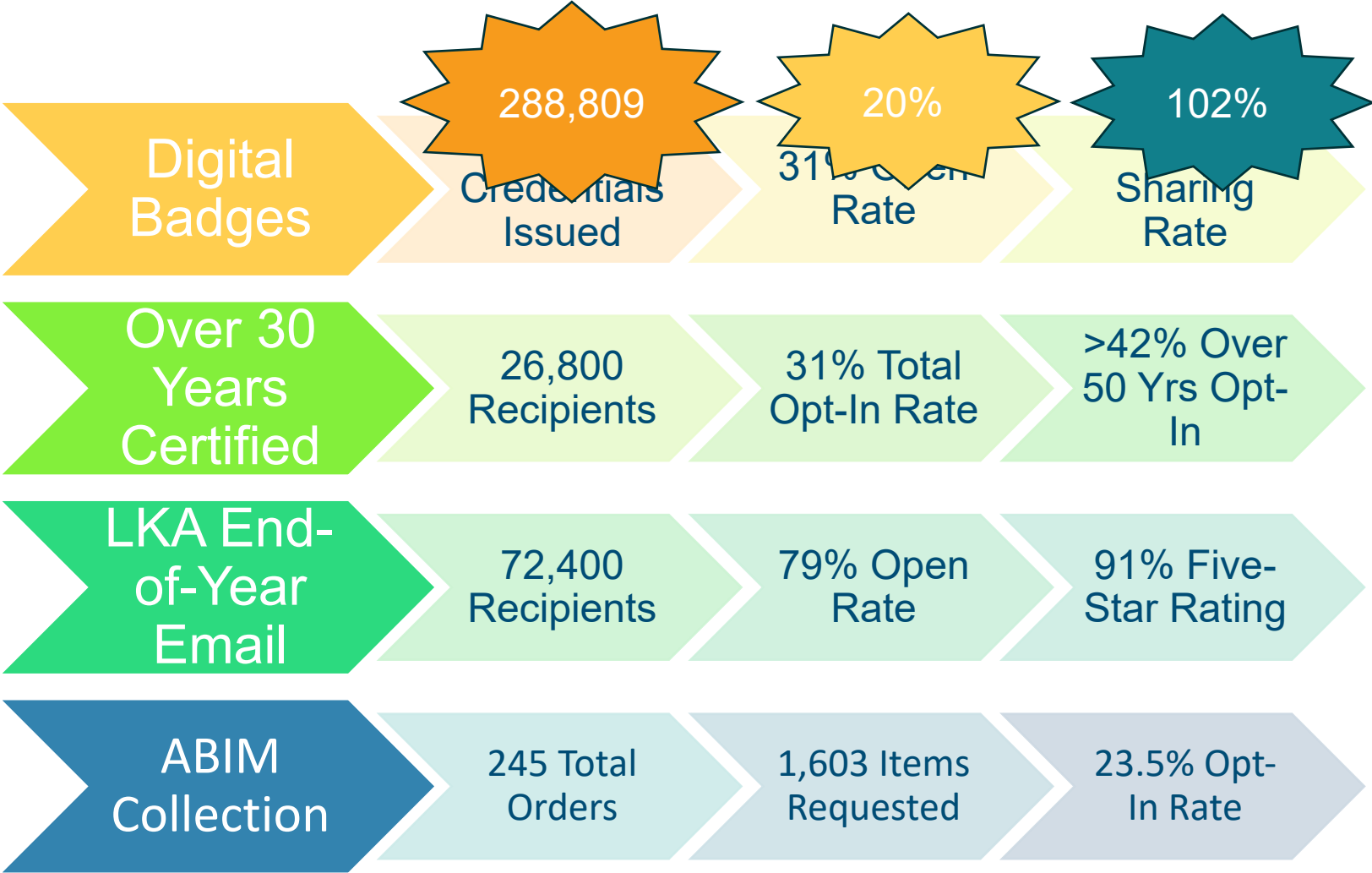
Official Launch

- **Strategic approach:**
Targeted pushes to smaller group of physicians allowing for better platform management
- Link to Collection on ABIM Physician Portal



Applying Lessons Learned

Key Metrics So Far



Over 30 Years

Sent: Tuesday, November 25, 2025 12:19 AM
To: ABIM Community Engagement <community@ABIM.ORG>
Subject: Re: Celebrating Your 37 Years of Board Certification

EXTERNAL

dear Dr Fuman
This message made my day. I can not describe my feelings of joy and happiness and fulfillment when I saw this message. It was especially hard for me living in Pakistan and maintaining my certification but with your support I did It So many have benefited from what I learnt from ABIM process of certification.
Thank u again
Kind regards



Scot Lewey, DO FACG FASGE AGAF ✓ • 3rd+
Advanced/Interventional/Therapeutic Endoscopist-...
5mo •



Over 30 Years Certified • Scot Lewey • American Board of Internal Medicine
badges.abim.org

25





Alfred Maksoud, MD ✓ • 3rd+
Pulmonary and Sleep Physicians of Houston, P.A.
5mo • Edited •



Over 30 Years Certified • Alfred Maksoud • American Board of Internal Medicine
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35





American Board of Internal Medicine
1w •

New blog alert! In celebration of 90 years of serving the profession, ABIM invited Dr. Georgia Newman to reflect on her 52-year long career in medicine and ... more



I do it because I love medicine and I love learning. I think of my patients as friends with medical problems, and that perspective has sustained me throughout my career.

Georgia Newman, MD, FACP



CELEBRATING





Cynthia X Pan
@CXPan55

Proud to maintain certification for over 30 years @ABIM ! Love Life Long Learning!



1:55 PM • Apr 25, 2026 • 140 Views

44

Board Certified Badge

 **Janak Koirala** • 3rd+
Professor Emeritus/ Past Division Chief of Infectious Disease, ...
7h • Edited • 

+ Follow ...

ABIM Certified in IM since 1996 and ID since 1999.
This official badge is a new way to be recognized online by the ABIM for maintenance of board certification by taking board exam every 10 years.



Board Certified • Janak Koirala • American Board of Internal Medicine
badges.abim.org

 10    

 **Jonathan Jenkin Tsui** • 3rd+
Assistant Professor (Clinical) School of Medicine, CUHK-Shenzhen...
21h • 

+ Follow ...

Grateful for my ABIM badge. A reminder to keep learning through CME, stay sharp through MOC, and never stop growing as a physician.



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 2    

 **Rafia Khan**  • 3rd+
Internal Medicine Physician | Site Director IM Residency Program | ...
[View my blog](#)
1h • 

+ Follow ...

A fun surprise in my inbox today! 🎉

Looks like the ABIM is keeping up with the times—I received my Board Certified digital badge. A small email, but a meaningful reminder of the commitment to lifelong learning and providing the highest standard of patient care.

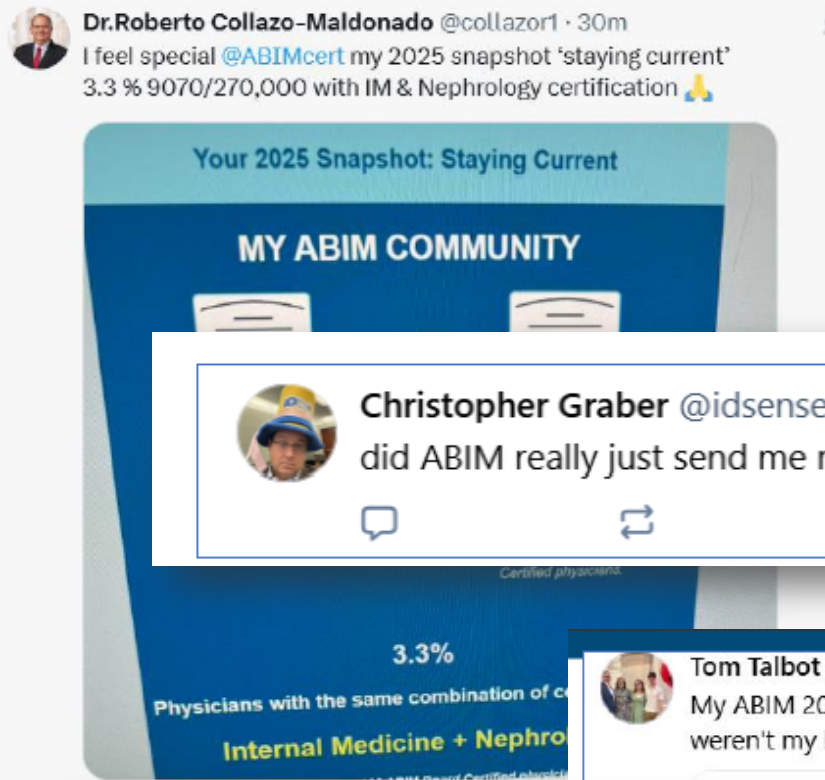
Proud to wear it—digitally. 😊

[#ABIM](#) [#BoardCertified](#) [#InternalMedicine](#)



 [American Board of Internal Medicine](#) 

Joshua Richter, MD, FACP @JoshuaRichterMD · 50m December 17
Ha ha ha. When @ABIMcert copies @Spotify and gives you a year end wrap up !! I would still chose anything Taylor swift does over ABIM any day
🤔. #mmsm #medtwitter



Christopher Graber @idsensei.bsky.social · 5d
did ABIM really just send me my LKA Wrapped?

December 17



Tom Talbot @trtalbot.bsky.social · 5d
My ABIM 2025 Summary -- Whew! Would have been embarrassed if these weren't my best topics!

December 17

EXTERNAL

Hi, the ABIM admin staff,

Thank you very much for the feedback of my current continuous maintenance studies. The periodic evaluation of the LKA is very important for us to know how I have performed so I can study the areas more. Greatly appreciate the ABIM administration team taking time to email individual physicians about the status. I will continue to study more of the updated medical knowledge and keep the medical skills current and relevant with help of the organization.

Thank you! Best wishes to all of you for the holidays and a very happy New Year! Look forward to achieving more next year!

Regards,



Best Overall Content Area

**Uncompromised Host (non-HIV
infection) + Vaccinations + Infection
Prevention and Control**

You got more questions right in this area than others.

ABIM Collection

"Really excited about the **stethoscope cases** as I have never had one. My brother and sister-in-law are both graduating from their residency/fellowship this year (one is cardiology the other is PMR and will of course be board-certified through ABIM) so I thought it would be a nice gift."

"Thank you for this kind gesture. I think the **members of Governance and others are going to enjoy this!**"



Tyson Garfield, DO,
ABIM Geriatric Medicine Board

Recognition Next Steps



Digital Badges

- Exploring an integration with systems for list management
- Subspecialty certificates and badges for LKA



Over 30 Years Certified

- October 2026 – reminders to 2025 cohort and notification of new cohort
- Exploring 10 and 50 years certified milestone markers



ABIM Collection

- Considering new vendor options for less manual work
- Exploring customizable features within platform (milestone tiers and other markers for recognition)



LKA End-of-Year Email

- December 2026 send will include new variables (cycle completion)
- Exploring other hyper-customized email campaigns

How might this apply to your work?

Do you have any questions about any of these processes?

Did you learn anything new that you might want to explore further?

Thank You!

Lindsay Durkalec, ldurkalec@abim.org

Patrick Prante, pprante@abim.org

Nicole Welk-Joerger, nwelk-joerger@abim.org



510 Walnut Street, Suite 1700, Philadelphia, PA 19106 | abim.org